```
✅🙂 irb
irb(main):001:0> require_relative "./counter"
=> true
irb(main):002:0> Counter.new
                 Counter.newPress Alt+d to read the full document
                            Counter.new

                            (from /Users/noel/.local/share/rdoc)
                            ----------------------------------------
                              new(initial_value=0)

                            ----------------------------------------

                            create a new Counter with the given
                            initial value
```

Ruby distributions document the built-in classes and modules this way. It's the documentation you'll see at https://docs.ruby-lang.org/en/master.

Adding RDoc to Ruby Code

RDoc parses Ruby source files to extract the major elements (such as classes, modules, methods, attributes, and so on). You can choose to associate additional documentation with these by simply adding a comment block before the element in the file.

One of the design goals of RDoc was to leave the source code looking totally natural. In most cases, there is no need for any special markup in your code to get RDoc to produce decent looking documentation. For example, comment blocks can be written fairly naturally:

```
# Calculate the minimal-cost path though the graph using Debrinkski's algorithm,
# with optimized inverse pruning of isolated leaf nodes.
def calculate_path
  . . .
end
```

You can also use Ruby's block-comments by including the documentation in a `=begin…=end` block. If you use this (which is not generally done), the `=begin` line must be flagged with an `rdoc` tag to distinguish the block from other styles of documentation:

```
=begin rdoc
Calculate the minimal-cost path though the graph using Debrinkski's algorithm,
with optimized inverse pruning of isolated leaf nodes.
=end
def calculate_path
        . . .
end
```

Within a documentation comment, paragraphs are lines that share the left margin. Text indented past this margin is formatted verbatim.

Nonverbatim text can be marked up. To set individual words in italic, bold, or typewriter fonts, you can use `_word_`, `*word*`, and `+word+`, respectively. If you want to do this to multiple words or text containing nonword characters, you can use `<em>multiple words</em>`, `<b>more words</b>`, and `<tt>yet more words</tt>`. Putting a backslash before inline markup stops it from being interpreted.